A comments sidebar for the portal's viewer

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Problem

Notes in a PDF are hard to follow. Each one is a small icon on the page with its replies hidden behind it, reviewer opens them one by one to read a conversation.

Teams that review contracts and reports tell us the same thing: they move the discussion to email, and the PDF stops being the place where decisions are made.

Proposal

Add a sidebar that lists every comment thread in reading order. A click on a thread scrolls to its mark on the page; replies and review states show in the sidebar, under the comment they answer.

The sidebar ~~replaces the old floating popups entirely~~, which keeps one place to read and write comments.

Phases

PHASE	WORK	WEEKS
1	The thread list, and scrolling to a thread's mark	2
2	Replies and review states	2
3	Filters and search	1

Open questions

How the sidebar looks on a phone. A sheet that slides up from the bottom is the likely answer, but it needs a mock-up before we decide.

Whether resolved threads stay in the list. Acrobat hides them behind a filter, and we lean towards the same.

Timeline

A design review on 21 October, then two sprints of work. The sidebar ships in 3.2.